H.R.H.R.C. ART COLLECTION

FREDERIC WILLIAMS COLLECTION (New Mexico sculptor, New York artist)
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(LEGEND: The legend is that F. Williams was a sculptor and rodeo rider. He performed in Madison Square Garden & kept an apartment in New York. He executed portrait heads of famous New Yorkers. Planning to write the most definitive book ever written on horses, he collected thousands of items relating to the horse. Souvenir horses in wood, plaster, glass, stone, stuffed, horses covered in real horse hide, embroidery, and paintings, as well as etchings & engravings. Also included in the collection is his clothing, cowboy clothing for rough wear and for parade dress; chaps embroidered with rose beading, black leather chaps, buckskin pants & jackets, Spanish concho riding ensemble, etc. Besides the portrait heads, included tourist items to sell in New Mexico, plaster statues of Indians and cowboys, bulls, rams, turtles. His memorial altars were unique creations of plaster in rising tiers of bas-relief plaster tableaus, when assembled, they formed altars, on which he placed candlesticks, also in plaster, and the animals of the Indian beliefs, turtles, eagles, etc., in three-dimensional additions.

Williams never married, and there were no direct heirs to the collection. Mr. Ohlendorf (husband of Mrs. Ohlendorf who was the curator of the Tinker Collection) spent two years when the collection first arrived, 1966, making a card catalogue, listing each of the almost ten thousand items, pottery, fabrics, clothing, art works, ceramics, glass, etc. Mr. Williams had just recently died then, but he had known Ransom and specified that his collection be sent here. It was stored at Balcones Research Center warehouse for several years. Many of the items disappeared from that warehouse, in particular a box of beautiful Spanish shawls, about six of them in a cardboard box, that I had been planning to bring back to HRC. ((It was reported to me by someone in the art department that a box of Spanish shawls was unpacked in the Art Dept. basement about that time.)

Apparently, cousins or some members of the Williams family contested the will & gift to the university. Dr. Ransom told me in 1972 that the collection was not really ours yet. He said that he had sent the file prepared by Ohlendorf to the New York lawyers and had not kept a copy. There is, however, in the Iconography Collection office, one drawer of cards made by Ohlendorf, marked art works. Mrs. Ohlendorf brought them to me, and she said that was all, she had no other card file drawers. Maybe this one drawer was just left behind.

Approximately 2,500 items from the collection have been listed, in the order they were retrieved from the Balcones warehouse. One breakfront full of Frederic Williams bric-a-brac at the Systems Offices, O. Henry Hall, has not yet been accessioned. These items were taken to Systems in the 1960's when the building first opened and no records kept.

The portrait heads in the Academic Center storage area are not catalogued.

"The Arrowmaker", sculptured figure on a bronze sundial is he work of Boston-born Frederic Williams, sculptor and scholar of the native arts of the American indian, the Mexican culture, and the civiization of Peru. He maintained a home at Taos, New Mexico, as well as an apartment in New York City, where he competed in international competitions in horse-shows and rodeos in Madison Square Garden. His sculptured portraits include those of Lindbergh and Washington, and he also designed memorial altars and commemorative medallions.
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FREDERIC ALLEN WILLIAMS Sculptor 1908-

Born West Newton, Mass., April 10, 1908, to Dr. Frederic Allen and Elizabeth Allen (Paine). Student Boston Latin School 1913-1917. Columbia University 1918-1920. Beaux Art Inst. of Design, 1921-1923. National Academy of Design, 1921-1929. Sculptures include: "The Arrowmaker" (Sundial), Arkel Museum Canjoharte, N.Y. Portrait busts of Edwin Markham, Percey MacKaye, Edgar Allan Poe Historic Arts Galleries, N.Y. Busts of Dan C. Beard, Will Rogers, Charlie Russell, Clyde Pangborn, Augustus Post, Alan Hawley, Ilya Tolstoi, Admiral R. Byrd, Poultney Bigelow (relief), Silago Nez (Navaho), portrait head of Edgar Stillman Kelley, Gallery of the American Academy of Arts & Letters, Charles Peter Berkey, Columbia University. Memorial tablet to Mrs. Thea Heye, Heye Foundation of the American Indian. Plaque portraits of Huge Eckner, Count Zeppelin, Town Hall Friedrichshafen, Ger. Exhibitions. The National Academy of Design, New York, The Architectural League of N.Y. The Am. Federation of the Arts, The National Sculpture Assoc. The San Francisco Sculpture Exposition. The Brooklyn Museum. Santa Fe Museum. Am. Vets Soc. of Artists, Inc. and others. Listed lecturer on Mexico, Indian Arts of the U.S., Arts of Mexico, Indian Arts of the U.S., Arts of Mexico. Indian Art of the Americas, The Arts of Peru, Pottery, Polychrome Sculpture. The Sculptures of New York demonstration, lecture of a sculptor working. for the coordinator of Inter-American Affairs. Pan-American Union. works reproduced in porcelain include llama, Rocky Mountain sheep, horse heads, fawn, frog, pelican, also done in porcelain. Madonna of the Americans; current work includes Shrine of the Americas, Pecos Bill and a monument to aeronaut Leo Stevens, . Received special award for the Madonna of the Americas in porcelain, Professional Artists League Show, N.Y.C. 1945. Am. Rough Riders, Inc. N.Y. Ceramic Soc. Am. Artists Professional League, Artist Guild, Sons of the Am. Revolution, Rodeo Cowboys Assn. Ends of the Earth, Trail Riders of the Canadian Rocky Minn. Historical Soc. Fla. Soc. in the East. Episcopalian. Author of articles: "America's Greatest Invention (Horse)", "Deep in the Heart of Texas," Pendleton Roundup", "Calgary Stampede", and others. Home: 58 West 57th Street, New York 19, N.Y.

Reprint from INTERNATIONAL WHO'S WHO, January 1948.